SANBI
Biodiversity for Life
South African National Biodiversity Institute

Document version history

Ver. No.	Ver. Date	Revised by	Description	Filename
1	06/02/2018	Fhatani Ranwashe	Metadata template	metadatatemplate
2	01/11/2018	Brenda Daly	Metadata template	metadatatemplate
3	28/06/2019	Brenda Daly	Provided descriptions for each field	metadatatemplate
4	15/01/2020	Brenda Daly	Added 'additional title'	metadatatemplate

METADATA REPORT

DATA IDENTIFICATION:	
Title	NVM2024Final_IEM5_12_07012025
Additional title	None
Description (detailed)	Latest update of the map of the National Vegetation Map Project and follows version VEGMAP 2018. All polygons are single-part. This file is also made available in geodatabase, shapefile format and as a cmf.
Purpose	To provide the potential or historical extent of ecologically based vegetation units of South Africa (including Prince Edward and Marion Islands), Lesotho and Swaziland at a landscape scale.
Status	Final version of National Vegetation Map: NVM 2024
Maintenance and :	This version has been updated since VEGMAP2018. **The following changes have been made since the 2018 version:** • Types removed: Blombos Strandveld • Types added in 2024: FS10 Southwestern Strandveld zFS11 Grootbos Strandveld FS12 Southeastern Strandveld FS13 Goukamma Strandveld FS14 St Franscis Strandveld SVcb29 Central Sandy Mountain Bushveld SVk17 Vryburg Thornveld SVk18 Morokweng Thornveld • Spatial changes to existing types in: o The whole North-West Province (all types) o VhaVenda Miombo o Elim Ferricrete Fynbos o Agulhas Sand Fynbos o Southern Afrotemperate Forest (additional polygons in the Langeberg) o Mangroves edited with new polygons added for both the historical and contemporary extent. o Corrected polygon extents for Fish Valley Thicket • New Fields o I_Colour_1 to provide a stable colour field for the symbology o Epoch_ex (epoch extent) to differentiate between the current and historical mangrove extents

update frequency

Topic category	Vegetation Classification and mapping
Lineage	This version of the vegetation map is an update of the 2018 version released in 2018. Previous versions of the map were 2018, 2009 and 2006 (original version). The source of the data for updated areas of the map were developed through contributions from various people including the people included in the contributors field (See Attribute Fields below)
Citation	South African National Biodiversity Institute (2006- 2024). The National Vegetation Map 2024 Online, https://bgis.sanbi.org/vegmap, Version 2024
Keywords	Vegetation, map, classification, historical map

Individual name	National Vegetation Map Team, Anisha Dayaram
Organisation name	South African National Biodiversity Institute
Position name	Vegetation Scientist
Contact Number	
Contact Address	Kirstenbosch Research Centre, Newlands, Cape Town
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Role	The National Vegetation Map Team is responsible for co-ordinating the collection of data for incorporation into the vegetation map where new data improves the mapping accuracy and classification.
Funders	South African National Biodiversity Institute

AUTHOR OF THE METADATA:	
Individual name	Anisha Dayaram
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Role	Author; Custodian; Distributor; Owner; Point of contact; Processor; User.

RESOURCE CONSTRAINTS:	
Access constraints	Copyright holder: South African National Biodiversity Institute
Use constraints	This data may not be reproduced by any means, nor redistributed via web site or ftp site, without prior permission. Whilst every effort has been made to ensure the accuracy of data, users are advised to use the data and conclusions drawn from its use with caution. Users noting errors and omissions are requested to notify the office of the VEGMAP project (Vegmap@sanbi.org.za) to improve data accuracy. These data are not for resale or replicating. This digital version is in the public domain requiring only the conventional acknowledgement of source in publications and reports.
Other restrictions	APPROPRIATE USE OF THIS DATASET: The VEGMAP has been created for national purposes and the boundaries of vegetation types are mapped at a coarse scale. While some vegetation types are mapped at a finer scale, these do not map vegetation past the level of subtype. Therefore the vegetation map may act as a guide to the vegetation in a region but is not appropriate for any work requiring fine scale investigations of communities or species beyond the landscape scale. Much of the map still requires field verification. More information on the clarity around appropriate use of the data can be discussed by contacting us.

SPATIAL RESOLUTION:

Spatial representation type	Geodatabase, Shapefile, Text, Vector.
Equivalent scale - Denominator	Various (See technical documents) 1:3000 to 1:50 000

COORDINATE REFERENCE SYSTEM: Custom	
Projected/Geographic coordinate system	PROJCS["AEA_RSA_WGS84",GEOGCS["GCS_WGS_1984",DATUM["D_WGS_1984",SPHEROID["WGS_1984",6378137 24.0],PARAMETER["Standard_Parallel_2",-33.0],PARAMETER["Latitude_Of_Origin",0.0],UNIT["Meter",1.0]]

COORDINATE REFERENCE SYSTEM:	
Projected/Geographic coordinate system	PROJCS["AEA_RSA_WGS84",GEOGCS["GCS_WGS_1984",DATUM["D_WGS_1984",SPHEROID["WGS_1984",6378137 24.0],PARAMETER["Standard_Parallel_2",-33.0],PARAMETER["Latitude_Of_Origin",0.0],UNIT["Meter",1.0]]
Geographic bounding box - East bound longitude	-14 278 400.00 Meters
Geographic bounding box - North bound latitude	900 705 647 074.10 Meters
Geographic bounding box - South bound latitude	-19 690 900.00 Meters
Geographic bounding box - West bound longitude	900 700 234 574.10 Meters

TEMPORAL EXTENT (time period covered by the content of the dataset):

Temporal extent - Begin date	1860
Temporal extent - End date	2024

Identification info Source data are recorded in Technical Documents

ONLINE RESOURCE (additional resources available online):	
Description	The Vegetation Map Project has various resources that link to the map dataset. These resources include the development of the original map, the methods used to develop updates

	to the original map, detailed descriptions of the vegetation types (i.e. the vegetation classification) and other information related to the project.
Linkage	Project Page: http://bgis.sanbi.org/vegmap Description of vegetation types: http://bgis.sanbi.org/Projects/Detail/171 Publications describing the development of the vegetation map: http://bgis.sanbi.org/Projects/Detail/192
NAME	NVM 2024
Protocol	See BGIS

LEGEND PROPERTIES:	
Classification	See attribute fields

DETAILED NOTES:	
Supplemental information	Methodology: Full details of the methodology can be found in the book The Vegetation of South Africa, Lesotho and Swaziland and in the Technical documents and journal papers available upon request from vegmap@sanbi.org.

The attribute field data can also be provided as a MS Excel spreadsheet and uploaded as an online resource.

ATTRIBUTE FIELDS		
Field Name	Description	Alias
OBJECTID	Internal feature number.	Object Identification
Shape	Feature geometry.	Shape
I_Color_1	Code for lyrx to display NVM colours	Integrated Map Colour
T_Name	Name of a national vegetation type	Name
T_MAPCODE	Code for a vegetation type. Types added in 2006 correspond with codes in Mucina and Rutherford (2006). Vegetation types added in subsequent versions have been assigned new codes. Follows BiomeCode+BioregionCode+Sequence.	Map code
T_BIOME	Name of Biome	Biome
T_BIOMEID	Biome Identity number	Biome Identity number
T_BIOREGION	Name of Bioregion	Bioregion
T_BRGNID	Bioregion Identity number	Bioregion Identity number
T_SUBTYPNM	Name of the subtype of the National Vegetation Type	Subtype Name
T_SUBTYPECD	Code for the sub-type of a vegetation type. These types are different at a scale which is too fine to warrant the definition of a new type at a national scale. Subtypes are represented by polygons with a name and code only, no descriptions are provided. Follows Mapcode12+Subtype Sequence.	Map code subtype
T_Plygn_Srce	The name of the data set that served as the source of the polygon delineation. In some cases these polygons were slightly modified from the original data.	Polygon Source
T_CHNGE_VER	If a polygon was affected by a refinement of a vegetation type after the 2006 release, this field indicates the version in which the polygon was changed. VM06 = Version 2006, VM09 = Version 2009, VM12 = Version 2012, VM18 = Version 2018, VM24= Version 2024.	Version in which polygon was edited
T_CHANGE_REF	Indicates the reference which guided the refinement of a vegetation type. Examples include: VegMap2006 = polygons that remain unchanged; NVMC=Decisions or refinements made by the National Vegetation Map Committee with the year and indication of the biome expert that digitized, re-assigned or made the decision for the edit captured in brackets; Lotter, M.C. (2014) refers to a publication.	Change reference
T_Cntrbtor_Main	Indicates the name/s of the main contributors of the spatial data only for each mapped unit. This does not refer to the person/s contributing to the descriptions of the vegetation type. Contributors of the mapped units from the original 2006 map have not changed and were determined from the 2006 publication. Where polygons have been updated the name of the person that mapped/edited the new unit is provided.	Main contributor
T_CNSRV_TRGT	Indicates the percent area of the vegetation type that should be conserved according to the National Biodiversity Assessment 2011. New vegetation types added in version 2009 and 2012 of the vegetation map were not included in this assessment. Therefore, interim values were assigned for these types by borrowing values from similar vegetation types. Interim values were based on a combination of descriptions from contributing partners and the extent and biogeographic	Conservation target

	association with similar or adjacent vegetation types. Values for new types in the Thicket Biome were assigned from the 2012 vegetation shape with which the new type shared the greatest extent.	
T_Crssrlm	Please see PRIMARYREALM_18 (above). This field provides more detail about the habitat from other realms especially where vegetation (non-terrestrial) has been mapped by other realms. The following list indicates which polygons should be considered part of the VEGMAP: National Coastal Map (Barrier Dunes) : These polygons are cross realms and part of the VEGMAP National Coastal Map (Foredunes) : These polygons are cross realms and part of the VEGMAP National Coastal Map (Parabolic Dunes) : These polygons are cross realm and part of the VEGMAP National Coastal Map (Transgressive Dunes) : These polygons are cross realm and part of the VEGMAP National Estuary Map (Estuary) : These polygons are not part of the VEGMAP but their spatial extent is delineated to indicate non-vegetated areas National Estuary Map (Microestuary) : These polygons are not part of the VEGMAP but their spatial extent is delineated to indicate non-vegetated areas National Estuary Map (vegetation) : These polygons are cross realm and part of the VEGMAP National Wetland Map (Limnetic waterbody) : These polygons are not part of the VEGMAP but their spatial extent is delineated to indicate non-vegetated areas 0 : These polygons part of the VEGMAP terrestrial realm only	Cross-Realm Description
T_CstalPolygn	Indicates which polygons were considered to be part of the coastal zone.	Coastal Polygon
T_Epoch_extent	This field indicates whether a polygon indicates the historical, contemporary, or a persistent extent of a type. This was derived using historical images from before 1960. In NVM2024 this field is only mapped for Mangrove Forests.	Epoch extent
Shape_Length	Automatically generated geodatabase value indicating the length of the polygon in meters	Shape Length
Shape_Area	Automatically generated geodatabase value indicating the length of the polygon in square meters	Shape Area

The descriptions of the metadata fields are provided and copyright of Open Source Geospatial Foundation. Available at https://geonetwork-opensource.org/manuals/2.10.4/eng/users/appendix/glossary_of_metadata/index.html